

0.0.1 Mettagu's Questions

1053. I ask that the Auspicious One answer
 this for me, (venerable Mettagu)
 I think the knowledge master is fully self-developed;

From where do these sufferings arise,
 whichever various kinds there are in the world.

1054. Truly you asked me about suffering's
 source, (the Auspicious One)
 that I will tell you just as I know it;
 suffering comes to be with ownership as its
 source,
 whichever various kinds there are in the world.

1055. Indeed not having known, when one
 makes ownership,
 that foolish one comes again and again to suffering;
 therefore surely knowing, one should not make
 ownership,
 seeing in accordance with the birth and origin
 of suffering.

1056. Of that which we asked, that you have
 answered for us, (venerable Mettagu)
 another that I ask, to that please speak;
 how do the wise cross beyond the flood,

birth, old age, sorrow and lamentation;
 that to me sage, please answer,
 for indeed, this dhamma is understood by you.

1057. I will explain the dhamma for you, (the
 Auspicious One)
 the dhamma that is seen, not from hearsay;
 which having known, faring mindfully,
 one could cross the world's adhesion.

1058. I greatly delight in that,
 O great sage, that unsurpassed dhamma;
 which having known, faring mindfully,
 one could cross the world's adhesion.

1059. Whatever you know, (the Auspicious
 One)
 above, below and across in the middle;
 dispelling delight and settling in these,
 consciousness does not persist in being.

1060. That vigilant one, dwelling thus mind-
 fully,
 the bhikkhu faring, having abandoned appro-
 priations;
 birth, old age, sorrow and lamentation,
 having known just this here, abandons suffer-
 ing.

1061. I greatly delight in this word of the great

seer, (venerable Mettagu)
 well proclaimed, O Gotama, is freedom from
 ownership;
 certainly, the Auspicious One has abandoned
 suffering,
 for indeed, this dhamma is understood by you.

1062. Surely those would abandon suffering
 as well,
 whoever you sage would constantly advise;
 having come to that very naga, I pay homage,
 it is well that the Auspicious One would con-
 stantly advise me.

1063. That brahmin, the knowledge master,
 the supremely knowing, (the Auspicious
 One)
 a disowner, not attached to sensual being;
 he has certainly crossed over this flood,
 and gone beyond to the further shore, without
 barrenness, free from doubt.

1064. That man here having known, the knowl-
 edge master,
 having relinquished this bond of being and
 non-being;
 he is free from thirsting, untroubled, desireless,
 he has crossed over birth and old age, I say.